

Directions for questions 1 to 10: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar, spelling and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. The accelerating urbanization of the world can be viewed as either the hope or the bane of our global future.
- b. Yet at a time when more than half of the world's population inhabit cities.
- c. and so much thought and study have been devoted to the challenges and possibilities of urban life.
- d. surprisingly a little attention is paid to the crucial purpose and meaning of cities.
- e. Recovering the cultural dimension in thinking about the future of our cities may be the best way to make them the solution and not the problem.

- ☐ a) a, c and e
- ☐ b) b, c and d
- ☐ c) b and d
- ☐ d) c and e

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

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Solution:

There is a subject verb mismatch in b. Here, the verb "inhabit" does not agree with the singular noun "population". The correction is "...half of the world's population inhabits cities". In d, the expression "a little" distorts the meaning of the sentence. "A little" means some, while "little" means none or practically nothing. It is explicit from the sentence that no attention has been paid to the purpose and meaning of cities. Hence, "little attention" is the correction here. Hence, a, c and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (A)

- a. Science has been central to the rise of the modern world.
- b. The practices of induction, observation, experimentation, theory testing, and falsification – and the invaluable products of those practices.
- c. have all had such profound effect on our culture and our ways of thinking.
- d. But as much as we have come to rely on it, science, like many other contemporary institutions.
- e. has been drawn into our highly politicized culture wars.

- ☐ a) b, c and d
- ☐ b) a, b and d
- ☐ c) a, b, c and d
- ☐ d) a and e

Solution:

Only a and e are grammatically correct. In b, the parenthetical clause "and the...practices" should be preceded and followed by a dash. Hence, a dash should be inserted after the word "practices". In c, the word "effect" should be written in the plural because the reference is to several practices and their effects. In d, the conjunction "but" should be replaced by "yet", meaning despite what has been just said.

Choice (D)

- a. Those of us living in the developed countries of the West find ourselves in the tightening grip of a paradox, one whose shape and character have so far eluded our understanding largely.
- b. It is the strange persistence of guilt as a psychological force in modern life.
- c. Guilt has not merely lingered.
- d. It has grown, even metastasized, into an ever more powerful and pervasive element in the lives of the contemporary West,
- e. even as the rich language formerly used to define it has withered and faded from discourse, and the means of containing its effects became ever more elusive.

- ☐ a) b and c
- ☐ b) b, c, d and e
- ☐ c) d and e
- ☐ d) b, c and e

Solution:

In a, the positioning of the adverb "largely" is incorrect. The adverb should precede the verb which it is modifying. Therefore, the correction is "...largely eluded our understanding". In d, the word "lives" does not match with its corresponding subject "the (contemporary) west" which is a singular noun. Hence, the correction is "in the life of the contemporary West". In e, the use of the simple past tense of the word "became" is incorrect. The verb should be written in the present perfect tense "has become" in order to maintain parallelism with the preceding verb "has withered" which is also in the present perfect tense. Only b and c are free of errors. Choice (A)

- a. Roughly a century ago, the eminent thinker and social critic Lewis Mumford argued that the United States had, to that point, endured three major migrations.
- b. The first extended the nation westward, across the Appalachians and eventually to Pacific.
- c. The second relocated a pastoral and agrarian population to small factory towns.
- d. The third migration, which began around the turn of the twentieth century fueled the growth of great urban metropolises.
- e. places defined by enormous manufacturing plants and tenements teeming with immigrants.

- ☐ a) a, c and d
- ☐ b) a, c and e
- ☐ c) b and c
- ☐ d) a and c

Solution:

In b, the word "Pacific" should be preceded by the definite article. In d, the parenthetical expression "which began.... century" should be preceded and followed by a comma. Hence, a comma should be inserted after the word "century" in order to demarcate the parenthetical clause from the rest of the sentence. In e, the word "teaming" does not make sense. "Teeming", meaning full of people, animals etc, is the appropriate word to be used here. Only a and c are grammatically correct. Choice (D)

- a. The elaborate system of pipes that carried water to Roman households was an engineering marvel—for it's time.
- b. Unfortunately, their sophisticated water utility may have been poisoning everyone.
- c. Scientists from the University of Southern Denmark used a mass spectrometer to determine the composition of a small piece of pipe recovered from the buried city of Pompeii.
- d. The pipe was composed largely of lead, but contained enough antimony to potentially sicken those drinking through it.
- e. The actual outcomes are not known, however, as antimony is expelled from the body in urine, meaning that it won't show up in bones examined by archeologists.

- ☐ a) a, c and d
- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) a, b and d
- ☐ d) d and e

Solution:

The errors are in a, d and e. In a, the expression "it's", meaning "it is" does not make sense. The pronoun "its" is appropriate because the corresponding subject, here, is the "elaborate system of pipes". In d, the word "drinking" should be followed by the preposition "from" and not "through". In e, the spelling of the word "archaeologists" is incorrect. Only b and c are grammatically correct.

Choice (B)

- a. Eclipses and their unsettling darkness have long inspired fear and awe — the precise reason some seek them.
- b. In the 19th century, eclipses became a scientific pursuit purely.
- c. But as travel became cheaper and easy, more people were able to experience, even chase, eclipses.
- d. Those tourists shared their experiences back home.
- e. And then came the internet, which spread that knowledge across the globe.

- ☐ a) a, d and e
- ☐ b) c and d
- ☐ c) d and e
- ☐ d) c, d and e

Solution:

In a, the word "seek" should be followed by "out". The phrasal verb "seek out", is appropriate in the context. To seek something out is to look or find somebody or something, especially when this means using a lot of effort. In b, it is quite explicit that the adverb "purely" is modifying the adjective "scientific", hence it should precede the adjective. Therefore, the correction is ".... became a purely scientific pursuit". In c, the adjective "easy" should be in the comparative degree, thereby maintaining parallelism in the sentence. Therefore, only d and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (C)

- a. When an earthquake occurs, it represents the release of years, sometimes decades or centuries, of pent-up stress.
- b. Somewhere along the fault line, a section of rock can take the strain no longer and gives away,
- c. allowing a tectonic plate to jerk into motion in a series of spasmodic shudders.
- d. The factors that determine when, where and why earthquakes happen are numerous, and we're still a long way from figuring out how to reliably predict them.
- e. But, it turns out that one of the many small stresses leading to an earthquake may be extraterrestrial.

- ☐ a) b and d
- ☐ b) a, c and d
- ☐ c) b and e
- ☐ d) c and d

- a. The Coral Triangle, home to more than three-quarter of the world's coral species and more than a thousand species of fish, is the underwater equivalent of the Amazon rainforest in terms of biodiversity.
- b. It encompasses an area half the size of the United States, and its warm, nutrient-rich waters harbor most marine species than anywhere else on the planet.
- c. At the Triangle's southeastern corner, off the Province of Papua and West Papua, is Cenderawasih Bay.
- d. Covering slightly more than 14,000 square kilometers (5,400 square miles), this is Indonesia's largest national park—
- e. and the location of one of the world's most spectacular aggregation of whale sharks.

- ☐ a) c and d
- ☐ b) a, b, c and d
- ☐ c) a, c and d
- ☐ d) a and d

- a. As a young man, St Augustine of Hippo loved hearing music in church.
- b. Even the simplest hymn would give him a keen pleasure and a psalm could move him to tears of joy.
- c. He was so enchanted so he would sometimes forget to pray.
- d. For a young Christian, this was quite worrying.
- e. Augustine was not the first person to grapple with the problem of liturgical music; by the time he was raised to the episcopate, it already had a long history.

- ☐ a) a, b and c
- ☐ b) b, c, d and e
- ☐ c) b, d and e
- ☐ d) a and e

Solution:

In b, the adjective "keen" should be in the superlative degree in agreement with the preceding adjective "simplest" which is also in the superlative degree. In c, "so...that" is the appropriate correlative conjunction to be used. Therefore, the correction is "He was so enchanted that...". In d, the use of the adverb "quite" is contextually inappropriate because "quite" cannot be used with negative words. It should be replaced by "rather". Therefore, the correction is "....this was rather worrying". Only a and e are correct in terms of grammar and usage.

Choice (D)

- a. The oasis city of Palmyra held the most unique position in the Syrian desert between Rome and the Parthian Empire, which ruled Persia from 247 BC to AD 224.
- b. Palmyra was unusual, occupying an outlying location and separated from other Syrian cities by a wide expense of desert.
- c. It, therefore, maintained a high level of independence and its citizens were able to claim protection and assistance from both the Roman or Parthian regimes.
- d. The local authorities in Palmyra raised and equipped their own regional troops to protect their territory from bandits and to keep control over the desert trails leading to their city.
- e. This allowed Palmyra to develop into a major centre for caravan trade passing from Babylonia and the Persian Gulf to Syria and the Mediterranean seaboard.

- ☐ a) a, d and e
- ☐ b) d and e
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) a, b and e

Solution:

In a, the expression "most unique" is grammatically incorrect. Since the word "unique" already conveys a superlative meaning, it need not be preceded by most. In b, the word "expense", is contextually incorrect. Expanse, meaning a wide and open area of something, especially land or water, is the appropriate word to be used in this sentence. In c, "or" should be replaced by "and" because "both....and" is the appropriate correlative conjunction to be used here. Only d and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, four different ways of presenting an idea are given. Choose the one that conforms most closely to standard English usage.

- ☐ a) Time and time again, India has proved itself to be, in the words of its first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, “a bundle of contradictions held together by strong but invisible threads.”
- ☐ b) Time and time again, India has proved itself to be, in the word of its first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, “a bundle of contradictions held together by strong but invisible threads.”
- ☐ c) Time and time again, India has proved itself to be, in the words of its first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, “a bundle of contradictions held together by strong and invisible threads.”

- ☒ d) Time and time again, India has proved itself to be, in the words of its first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, “a bundle of contradictions held together by strong but invisible threads.” (Correct Answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, four different ways of presenting an idea are given. Choose the one that conforms most closely to standard English usage.

- ☐ a) Nature provides us with an beautiful environment to live and enjoy so it is our responsibility to keep it clean and away from all the damages.

- ☒ b) Nature provides us with a beautiful environment to live and enjoy so it is our responsibility to keep it clean and away from all the damages. (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) Nature provides us with beautiful environment to live and enjoy so it is our responsibility to keep it clean and away from all the damages.
- ☐ d) Nature provides us with a beautiful environment to live and enjoy so its our responsibility to keep it clean and away from all the damages.

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, four different ways of presenting an idea are given. Choose the one that conforms most closely to standard English usage.

- ☐ a) Indian flora has a greater range of varieties from the coniferous to the evergreen, from scrubs to deciduous forests and thick tropical jungles to cool temperate woods.
- ☐ b) Indian flora has a great range of varieties from the coniferous to the evergreen, from scrubs to deciduous forests and thick tropical jungle to cool temperate woods.
- ☒ c) Indian flora has a great range of varieties from the coniferous to the evergreen, from scrubs to deciduous forests and thick tropical jungles to cool temperate woods. (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) Indian flora has a great range of varieties from the coniferous to the evergreen, from scrubs to deciduous forests and thick tropical jungles to cooler temperate woods.

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, four different ways of presenting an idea are given. Choose the one that conforms most closely to standard English usage.

- ☐ a) The majesty of the snow-clad peaks visible from afar, the inaccessibility of the even much lesser ranges, the mysteries of the gigantic glaciers and the magnificent rivers that emerge on the gorges, have combined to give the Himalayas a majesty that no other mountain range can ever claim.
- ☐ b) The majesty of the snow-clad peaks visible from afar, the inaccessibility of the even much less ranges, the mysteries of the gigantic glaciers and the magnificent rivers that emerge from the gorges, have combined to give the Himalayas a majesty that no other mountain range can ever claim.
- ☐ c) The majesty of the snow-clad peaks visible from afar, the inaccessibility of the even much lesser ranges, the mysteries of the gigantic glaciers and the magnificent rivers that emerge from the gorges, has combined to give the Himalayas a majesty that no other mountain range can ever claim.
- ☒ d) The majesty of the snow-clad peaks visible from afar, the inaccessibility of the even much lesser ranges, the mysteries of the gigantic glaciers and the magnificent rivers that emerge from the gorges, have combined to give the Himalayas a majesty that no other mountain range can ever claim. (Correct Answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, four different ways of presenting an idea are given. Choose the one that conforms most closely to standard English usage.

- ☐ a) The increasing number of teenage suicides in the country are a confirmation of the long speculated belief that children are becoming more and more isolated in this connected-by technology age.
- ☒ b) The increasing number of teenage suicides in the country is a confirmation of the long speculated belief that children are becoming more and more isolated in this connected-by technology age. (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) The increasing number of teenage suicide in the country is a confirmation of the long speculated belief that children are becoming more and more isolated in this connected-by technology age.
- ☐ d) The increasing number of teenage suicides in the country is an confirmation of the long speculated belief that children are becoming more and more isolated in this connected-by technology age.